GPO ANNUAL REPORT 2024

LETTER FROM THE DIRECTOR

This year the Office completed its transition to a digital-first publishing model. We retired the last of the legacy composition systems in March 2024 and moved all statutory publications onto the new platform. Staff across three facilities contributed to the effort, and I am grateful for their persistence through a demanding schedule.

Our priorities for the coming year are continuity of the statutory programme, further automation of the deposit workflow, and a measured expansion of the preservation programme described later in this report.

FINANCIAL HIGHLIGHTS

Total revenue for fiscal year 2024 was 1,284.6 million dollars, an increase of 6.2 per cent over the 1,209.3 million dollars recorded in fiscal year 2023. Revenue from congressional publishing accounted for 412.8 million dollars, while agency publishing services contributed 611.4 million dollars. The remaining 260.4 million dollars came from information dissemination and other sources.

Operating expenses totalled 1,197.2 million dollars against 1,151.8 million dollars in the prior year. Personnel costs represented 64 per cent of operating expenses. Net operating income was 87.4 million dollars, compared with 57.5 million dollars in fiscal year 2023.

Capital expenditure was 48.9 million dollars, directed principally at the replacement of two web presses at the Washington facility and at the second phase of the digital preservation repository.

WORKFORCE

Headcount at 30 September 2024 stood at 1,742 full-time equivalent employees, down from 1,803 a year earlier. The reduction was achieved entirely through attrition and voluntary separation; there were no involuntary separations during the year. The median length of service was 11.4 years.

Forty-one apprentices were enrolled across the printing, binding and platemaking trades, the largest intake since 2016. The apprenticeship programme runs for four years and leads to journeyman certification.

Employee engagement, measured by the annual survey, rose to 71 per cent favourable from 68 per cent in the previous year. The survey response rate was 83 per cent.

DIGITAL PRESERVATION PROGRAMME

The preservation repository now holds 3.9 petabytes of content, comprising 2.1 million distinct publications. During the year the Office ingested 184,000 new items, of which 41,000 were retrospective digitisations of pre-1976 material.

Three preservation tiers are maintained. Tier one holds master files in uncompressed form at two geographically separate sites. Tier two holds derivative access copies. Tier three holds a dark archive copy written to tape and verified on a six-month cycle. Fixity checking runs continuously across all three tiers; during the year 11 checksum mismatches were detected and all 11 were repaired from redundant copies.

The repository achieved certification against the ISO 16363 trustworthy digital repository standard in July 2024, following an audit that began in October 2023.

FEDERAL DEPOSITORY LIBRARY PROGRAMME

The depository programme served 1,086 participating libraries at year end, a net decrease of 28 from the prior year. Twenty-two libraries withdrew and six were newly designated. Regional depositories numbered 44.

Distribution to depositories was 92 per cent electronic by title count. Tangible distribution continued for 614 titles judged to require a physical copy under the essential titles list.

The programme delivered 37 training webinars attended by 4,210 library staff, and published the revised Depository Library Handbook in September 2024.

SUSTAINABILITY

Greenhouse gas emissions from facility operations were 24,100 metric tons of carbon dioxide equivalent, a reduction of 9 per cent against the 2019 baseline. Paper procurement reached 68 per cent recycled content by weight. Waste diverted from landfill was 54 per cent.

The Washington facility completed a lighting retrofit in May 2024 that is expected to reduce electricity consumption by 1.8 million kilowatt hours annually.

GOVERNANCE AND RISK

The principal risks identified by the Office are concentration of specialised printing capability at a single site, cyber security exposure arising from the expanded digital estate, and the demographic profile of the skilled trades workforce. Mitigation plans for each are reviewed quarterly by the Executive Committee.

An independent audit of financial statements was conducted and issued an unmodified opinion. There were no material weaknesses in internal control over financial reporting.